

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Actual Appearances and Disclosure Statements

United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit United States v. Mateo Serrano
Appeal No. SYN-CA4-26-CR-4201 Document 4 Filed March 23, 2026

Celia Arden enters an appearance for appellant Mateo Serrano through the fictional Federal Defender Exercise Office for the Middle District of North Carolina. Bram Ives enters an appearance for appellee United States through the Synthetic United States Attorney's Office for that district. Both counsel participated below and are admitted solely within this training record.

All names and offices are fabricated. The filing provides no real bar number, mailing address, telephone number, email address, login credential, or electronic-filing account. Service occurs through the closed exercise channel recorded by Fourth Circuit Exercise Clerk Maela Cross.

Arden is lead counsel for appellant. Ives is lead counsel for appellee. Each agrees to receive notices, orders, and schedule changes through the synthetic docket. Neither appearance alters the roles of District Judge Elara Venn, Probation Officer Niko Faye, District Clerk Tessa Wren, or the composite appellate panel.

Appellant Disclosure

Mateo Serrano is a fictional natural person, not a corporation, association, publicly held company, subsidiary, parent entity, or issuer of publicly traded securities. No corporate ownership disclosure applies to him. No nongovernmental entity has a financial interest in the outcome identified by this exercise.

The caption accurately identifies the parties. Serrano was the defendant in district docket SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 and is the appellant in this docket. He appeals the February 25 judgment through the timely March 11 notice. He has not transferred an interest in the appeal or authorized another person to litigate in his name.

Arden identifies no additional party whose participation would require recusal. The fictional Meridian Community Supply Cooperative is the restitution recipient described in public sentencing sources, not a party to the criminal appeal. Its synthetic interest does not create a real financial conflict. The other four charged participants are not parties to this appeal, although protected record material may refer to them.

Appellee Disclosure and Conflict List

The fictional United States is a governmental party and has no parent corporation or publicly held owner. The Synthetic United States Attorney's Office is an exercise office, not a separate party or beneficiary. Ives identifies no private entity funding or directing the government's appellate position.

For conflict-screening within the exercise, counsel identify Mateo Serrano, Celia Arden, Bram Ives, Elara Venn, Mira Lorne, Niko Faye, Tessa Wren, Kellan Rhys, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, Nessa Holt, and Meridian Community Supply Cooperative. Each is fictional. The names do not correspond intentionally to a real person or organization.

No merits panel has been assigned as of this filing. Counsel will review the later public calendar notice for the assigned judges and will report any newly discovered exercise conflict to the clerk without disclosing confidential presentence content. This disclosure predicts no panel composition or judicial action.

Joint Certification and Confidentiality Boundary

Both counsel certify that these appearance and disclosure statements are complete as of March 23, 2026. They will update an administrative fact if needed. They also certify that the filing contains no real personal identifier, authentic office contact, credential, presentence report excerpt, or actionable description of the fictional offense.

The lower record includes automatically protected presentence documents and public surrogates. Entry of counsel appearances does not grant public access to a sealed volume. Any later use of protected information must comply with the appellate sealed-material procedure and preserve an equal-page public counterpart or appropriate docket surrogate.

Arden and Ives acknowledge that ordinary public service may include only public filings. Protected twins travel through the fictional sealed channel and remain subject to disclosure-specific access. Counsel's lawful exercise access cannot be shared with an unauthorized user or represented as access to PACER, CM/ECF, Probation, or a real court system.

Celia Arden Fictional Counsel for Appellant

Bram Ives Fictional Counsel for Appellee